

Analyze your game before using an engine

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

Your own analysis reveals what you saw, missed, and misunderstood during the game. Write candidate moves and critical moments first, then use an engine to test them. Otherwise you may collect strong moves without learning why your decisions failed.

WORKED EXAMPLE

After a loss, identify where you first felt uncertain and what you expected the opponent to do. Compare those expectations with the actual reply. The engine then helps distinguish a calculation error from a flawed plan.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you record at a critical moment?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Your intended plan, considered candidates, expected reply, and time spent. Add the improved explanation after checking. This makes the lesson about your thinking process, not merely the final blunder.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Use analysis tools to test your reasoning, not replace its diagnosis.